

Give my love to
 Mary Kiss the
 little ones and
 tell me how
 you are getting on
 (Henry)

Dear Home

plus-jour nous appren-

But barely covered what I wanted when we joined in the

advance of the army here, reaching here the morning of Monday the 5th
next and entering the city among the first regiments.

Since then I have been very busy getting up the regimental
papers and books which had not only been lost at the fight here in July last
but had also never been properly kept since I left the regiment in March
last, and I found letters from Gen^l. Robertson of Michigan and Gen^l. Thomas
at Washington stating that no such returns for this regiment had been
received since March 1862. It has kept me hard at work and in
addition thereto I have been appointed by Gen^l. Thomas as a Inspector
Gen^l. which adds to my duties considerably. The regiment did good
service here during the fight although not under any heavy fire
by checking a ~~panic~~^{panic} which would otherwise have spread through the
entire night ring of our army, and for their behavior were highly
complimented by Gen^l. Thomas' Chief of Staff and by the General
himself. There is no reason that I see why we should not now do
well if the officers would do their duty. But I am sorry to say
that there is not the zeal manifested by them that the circumstances
demand. Parkhurst could be one of the most efficient commanding
officers we could desire, indeed I think he will be anywhere but
here, but the besetting sin seems to have taken hold of him
again and not a night passes that finds him in camp. He
and our acting Major Captain Rounds are gone every night
and good old Major Milburne, who thinks I am a model
soldier and an oracle on military matters, comes in regularly
and says, "Well Adjutant you and I have got the regiment to run again
tonight I guess they had better let us run it altogether." This course
necessarily produces great dissatisfaction among the subordinate
officers especially those who were here in July last and saw the
evil consequences. Nor can I blame them. To tell the truth I cannot

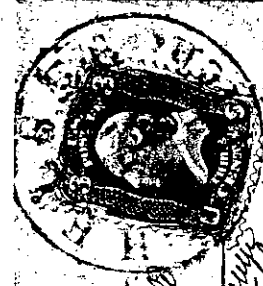
sleep easy until I have personally gone the rounds of the guards
and ascertained that they are at their posts. It may be for Col
Anklam to act this way but for Rounds a married man and one who
was hopes, and is striving for promotion it is the very worst course to take
the officers have lost all respect for him and he has shown himself
terribly ignorant of his duties. At the time of the stampede Wednesday
morning the Colonel had to send me to the left of the line to form
the men into shape. He (Rounds) had thrown out no guides and being
muddled up like sheep with no formation whatever were in imminent
danger of being ordered over by the the frightened fugitives and sharing in the
panic. Another cause of discontent is the promotions that have been and
are being made in the regiment. When I returned to the regiment I saw
that there would be trouble on this score and having declined long
ago a captaincy and feeling that the only objection to my filling even
a higher position, if any objection existed, was my youth, added to the
fact that there was much work to be done in the Adjutant's office
before the regiment was in running order, ^{and no one competent to do it,} I declined the recommendation
offered by Major Wilkinson, who very kindly so stated in his letter to the
Governor. Lieut's Barrows (S.S.) & Moore being the poorest fitted for and
deserving of promotion have been commissioned as Captains thus
jumping Lieut's Higgins, Conley, Wright, Puddy & Barrow (Hiland)
who are among the best officers we have. Moore's commission
the Colonel has withheld and written relative thereto to the
Governor but Barrows brought his with him and is a fixture.
The consequence you can readily imagine, one does not fancy after
seventeen months hard service to be cut out of his promotion, which a
soldier most desires, by a junior and a poorer officer and it has
caused great discontent.

But to look at the bright side of the picture, the "7th"

ms/ Duffield (S.P.)
1863, Jan. 19

has gained great credit for her part in the recent advance upon
and battle at, Appomattox, she is well known at Nashville as the
Regiment that checked the stampede and has negotiated her
into the favor of Genl. Thomas who rumor says is going to have
command here vice Rosecrans who will go to the Potomac
The men are in good health and spirits needing drill somewhat
but in excellent discipline Thomas comes over to see us often and
even went so far as to go out himself personally and pick
a camp for us the Friday we were coming from Nashville
His Inspector Genl. offered me in behalf of the General a place
on his staff but I had rather tired of "acting" appointments after
eight-months experience, and the Major was very unwilling for
me to leave the 9th, so I accepted the duties of a Inspector Genl.
but still hold my place with the Regiment and claim some of
the honors or privileges. It makes a little more work for me
but I fancy that all the better. Works drives away care and
keeps off the blues. I am sorry to be compelled to report Major McKim
quite sick and we sent him over to Major McCreary this morning
The Doctor says he don't think he will be sick long but I am a little
fearful for him. His short illness of two or three days has pulled him
down a great deal. We are having very much weather but plenty of
rain and mud. Almost all your acquaintances in fact all except
Major McCreary have joined the rebel service. The country is stripped of
inhabitants and everything else you could not know it. I wrote to
Father to mule "Pet" at home or in Adair. I don't want to sell him
but want him here as soon as an opportunity occurs. He can be
muled for four or six dollars a month in the country, George
could find a place for him by inquiring of Mr. Rice the man
who keeps Pete, I mean by muling to let him run loose in
a field with mule environment and a stick to run into. Get him

My dear Valeria - please
 attend to this - I have the
 day rejected - Col. W. W. Suffer
 think Michigan and I in favor of
 The Union with us. They are the only
 all they can get as they
 are going to be in the
 of the part of the battle.
 The "part of honor" - President - Soldier - Aid Society
 but the part of danger also - Detroit
 if we cannot pay off merchants
 they had better as they are probably sent to Michigan
 friends



Hardin County
 Mrs. Druffield Kentucky